README for Replication Package

Municipality Proliferation

June 26, 2026

Overview

This replication package contains the Stata and R code used to construct the analysis data and reproduce the tables and figures for *Shattered Metropolis: The Great Migration and The Fragmentation of Political Jurisdictions*. The main entry point is `code/master.do`. That file sets up the file structure of the replication package, constructs cleaned/interim datasets, and then runs the analysis scripts that write tables to `exhibits/tables` and figures to `exhibits/figures`. A considerable dependency of this replication is the output of the replication package of Derenoncourt (2022a). We provide instructions on how to set up their package and provide modified versions of their programs that produce the necessary output, while omitting those extraneous for computational brevity. To execute the replication, users should update the if-else block of global paths in `code/master.do` to reflect where they've downloaded the data and code for the replication, as well as their version of Rterm.exe.

Data Availability and Provenance Statements

Statement About Rights

- ☐ I certify that the author(s) of the manuscript have legitimate access to and permission to use the data used in this manuscript.
- ☐ I certify that the author(s) of the manuscript have documented permission to redistribute/publish the data contained within this replication package.

TODO: Check these boxes only after confirming the redistribution terms for all raw and derived inputs, especially IPUMS extracts, Derenoncourt replication inputs, CoreLogic-derived files, and any court-order or school-achievement files.

License for Data

TODO: Specify the data license for the replication package. The repository contains a `LICENSE` file, but this README draft does not determine whether it covers code only or both code and redistributed data. Some source data may have inherited licenses or redistribution restrictions.

Summary of Availability

- ☐ All data are publicly available.
- ☑ Some data cannot be made publicly available.
- ☐ No data can be made publicly available.

The majority of data are publicly available, with two exceptions. First, the ICPSR restricted access data used in the Derenoncourt (2022b) replication files. An affiliation with an ICPSR member institution is required to access these resources. The readme of Derenoncourt (2022b) provides instruction on how to access these. Second, while we provide the derived city-level Corelogic data, the microdata used to produce it are not publicly available.

Raw Dataset List

Data source	Files or folders used by code	Expected location	Notes	Citation
Derenoncourt replication package	`dcourt/replication_AER/`; includes Derenoncourt migration, crosswalk, city population, industry employment, and mechanism files used throughout the pipeline.	`data/raw/dcourt/replication_AER/`; outputs also written to `data/interim/dcourt/`.	Need to obtain restricted access data from ICPSR per package readme.	Derenoncourt (2022b)
C. Goodman municipal incorporation data	`cbgoodman/muni_incorporation_date.dta`	`data/raw/cbgoodman/`	Used to construct municipal incorporation outcomes and shapefile attributes.	Goodman (2023)
1930-40 Linked Census	`census/usa_00072.dta/usa_00072.dta`	`data/raw/census/`	Used by `black_linked_characteristics.do` for linked Black migrant characteristics.	Ruggles et al. (2025b)
1900-50 Full Count Censuses	`census/usa_00108.dta/usa_00108.dta`, `census/usa_00109.dta/usa_00109.dta`, `census/usa_00110.dta/usa_00110.dta`, `census/usa_00111.dta/usa_00111.dta`, `census/usa_00116.dta/usa_00116.dta`, `census/usa_00118.dta/usa_00118.dta`	`data/raw/census/`	Used by `cz_pop_occscore_mfg.do` for full-count CZ population, race, OCCSCORE, and manufacturing share variables.	Ruggles et al. (2025a)
Census Gazetteer / national county file	`census/national_county.txt`	`data/raw/census/`	Used by `place_county_xwalk.do` to build the place-county crosswalk	U.S. Census Bureau (2025)
Census Gazetteer / national places file	`census/national_places.txt`	`data/raw/census/`	Used by `place_county_xwalk.do` to build the place-county crosswalk.	U.S. Census Bureau (2025)
Census place FIPS crosswalk	`census/census_place_fips_xwalk.txt`	`data/raw/census/`	Used by `incomes.do` and `mechanisms.do` to translate 1970 Census place codes to FIPS place codes.	U.S. Census Bureau (2013)
Geocorr block-group to place crosswalk	`census/geocorr/geocorr2014_mo_il.csv`, `census/geocorr/geocorr2014_in_ne.csv`, `census/geocorr/geocorr2014_nv_sc.csv`	`data/raw/census/geocorr/`, `census/geocorr/geocorr2014_sd_wy.csv`	Used by `incomes.do` for 2010 place-level household income. **TODO:** Confirm Geocorr parameters and access date.	Missouri Census Data Center (2014)

Data source	Files or folders used by code	Expected location	Notes	Citation
NHGIS extracts	`census/nhgis0017_csv/`, `census/nhgis0019_csv/`, `census/nhgis0020_fixed/`, `census/nhgis0025_csv/`, `census/nhgis0027_csv/`, `census/nhgis0035_csv/`, `census/nhgis0036_csv/`, `census/nhgis0038_csv/`, `census/nhgis0041_csv/`, `census/nhgis0046_csv/`, `census/nhgis0048_csv/`, `census/nhgis0052_csv/`	`data/raw/census/`	Used by `cz_place_race_pop_1970_2010.do`, `cz_pop_occscore_mfg.do`, `municipal_shapefile.R`, `incomes.do`, `maxcitypop.do`, `dataprep.do`, and `mechanisms.do` for county/place race, population, education, income, manufacturing, and mover measures. **TODO:** Add NHGIS extract citations, access dates, and confirm all files required by the Stata import script.	**?**
Census TIGER/Line place shapefiles	`census/tiger/states/tl_2022_*_place.shp` and sidecar files	`data/raw/census/tiger/states/`	Used by `municipal_shapefile.R`	U.S. Census Bureau (2022)
Census cartographic/TIGER cache	tigris-downloaded county/place shapes cached under `census/tiger/CB`, `census/tiger/full`, and `census/tiger/states_2011/`.	`data/raw/census/tiger/` or downloaded by R package `tigris`.	Used by R spatial cleaning scripts. Requires network access if the tigris cache is not pre-populated.	U.S. Census Bureau (2021); U.S. Census Bureau (2022)
Census of Governments crosswalks	`cog/4_Govt_Org_Directory_Surveys/GOVS_ID_to_FIPS_Place_Codes_2002.xls`, `cog/1-3_Govt_Org_Nat_CoArea_ElecOff/GOVS_to_FIPS_Codes_State_&_County_2007.xls`, `cog/1-3_Govt_Org_Nat_CoArea_ElecOff/2012_GOVS_COUNTY_to_FIPS_COUNTY.xls`	`data/raw/cog/`	Used by `cog_cleaning.do` to build the COG to FIPS crosswalks.	U.S. Census Bureau (2014)
Census of Governments county counts	`cog/1-3_Govt_Org_Nat_CoArea_ElecOff/2_Govt_Org_County_Area_Counts.xls`	`data/raw/cog/`	Used by `cog_cleaning.do` for municipal, county, school district, and special district counts.	U.S. Census Bureau (2014)
Census of Governments individual-government directory	ODBC DSN `4_Govt_Org_Directory_Surveys`, pointing to the downloaded database/files under `cog/4_Govt_Org_Directory_Surveys/`.	`data/raw/cog/` plus local ODBC DSN	Used by `cog_cleaning.do` for tables 2–4 of individual governments. Requires ODBC setup to access.	U.S. Census Bureau (2014)
Census Government Units file	`cog/Govt_Units_2021_Final.xlsx`	`data/raw/cog/`	Used by `cog_cleaning.do` for the 2021 master unit file. **TODO:** Confirm exact citation.	U.S. Census Bureau (2014)
Census historical city finance database	ODBC DSN `City_Gov_Fin`, table `City_Govt_Finances`.	`data/raw/cog/` or other local database path	Used by `cog_cleaning.do` for historical city-government finance variables. Requires ODBC setup to access.	U.S. Census Bureau (2012)
Census Individual Finance file	`census/_IndFin_1967-2012/IndFin12a.txt`, `census/_IndFin_1967-2012/IndFin12b.txt`, `census/_IndFin_1967-2012/IndFin12c.txt`	`data/raw/census/_IndFin_1967-2012/`	Used by `IndFin_cleaning.do` to build `data/interim/census/IndFin12.dta`	U.S. Census Bureau (2012)

Data source	Files or folders used by code	Expected location	Notes	Citation
NCES / CRDC / EDFacts / EDGE school data	nces/school-districts_lea_directory.csv; nces/EDGE_SCHOOLDISTRICT_TL23_SY2233/.../EDGE_SCHOOLDISTRICT_TL_23_SY2223.shp; pre-generated school_ccd_directory.dta, school_offerings.dta, school_race_ccd.dta, cz_achievement_segregation.dta.	data/raw/nces/; data/interim/nces/; data/xwalks/ncessch_place_xwalk.dta.	Used for school district geography, offerings, race/enrollment, court-order shares, and school segregation/achievement outcomes.	NCES (2017); NCES (2023); Reardon et al. (2024)
School desegregation / court-order data	other/district_court_order_data_feb2021.dta	data/raw/other/	Used to construct commuting-zone court-order variables.	Sean F. Reardon and Greenberg (2012)
GNIS domestic names / streams	Files under GNIS/DomesticNames_AllStates_Text/Text/.	data/raw/GNIS/	Used to count stream features by commuting zone.	U.S. Board on Geographic Names (2026)
Transportation and railroad covariates	covariates/RR_NetworkDatabase_DH_Oct2015/.../Cost_ID_county.xlsx; NSFtranspCost.dta; Historical_Railroads___Vanderbilt.shp.	data/raw/covariates/	Used for transport cost and rail density controls.	Donaldson and Hornbeck (2016); Atack (2016)
Coastline and climate covariates	coastline-counties-list.xlsx; NOAA/NCEI climdiv-*.txt.	data/raw/covariates/	Used for coastal status and 1940 climate controls.	U.S. Census Bureau (2018); Vose et al. (2014)
CoreLogic-derived place characteristics	corelogic/censusplace_clogic_chars.csv	data/interim/corelogic/	Used in municipal shapefile attributes and mechanisms.	CoreLogic (2023)
1990 CZ-County Crosswalk	cw_cty_czone.dta	data/raw/david_dorn/	Used to define county-cz crosswalk	Autor and Dorn (2013)

Final Dataset List

Dataset	Description	Created by
`data/clean/cz_pooled.dta`	Main commuting-zone analysis dataset; merges Derenoncourt city/CZ data, municipal outcomes, school district outcomes, controls, instruments, court-order variables, streams, population, income, education, and shift-share objects.	`code/cleaning/dataprep.do`
`data/clean/mechanisms.dta`	Place-level mechanisms dataset used for long-run mechanism, white-flight, distance, finance, land-use, and school exclusivity analyses.	`code/cleaning/mechanisms.do`
`data/clean/panel_a_data.dta`	Data for the paper's first-panel migration/instrument figure.	`code/cleaning/panel_a_data.do`
`data/clean/pcarrow_fig_data.dta`	Data for principal-city arrow figures.	`code/cleaning/pcarrow_fig_data.do`

Computational Requirements

Software Requirements

The main code is Stata and R. `code/master.do` declares `version17.0`, so Stata 17 or newer is recommended. The preferred R version for replication is R 4.4.2. Replicators should set `$Rterm_path` in `code/master.do` to the local R 4.4.2 executable before running the code. The replication was performed using Windows 11; no Linux/macOS run has been verified.

- Stata 17 or newer.
- R 4.4.2.
- Stata community packages can be installed by running `docode/setup_stata_packages.do` from the repository root. The setup script installs the Stata packages used by the active project code and by the edited Derenoncourt replication scripts, including those found in `code/dependencies/stata_packages.csv`.
- R package versions are found in `code/dependencies/r_packages.csv`. `code/setup_r_packages.R` reads that file and installs the locked CRAN versions using `remotes::install_version(...,upgrade="never")`. This requires internet access unless the exact package versions are already installed.
- The Tigris/Line shapefiles and the NCES data was downloaded via API using the R package `tigris` and Stata package `educationdata`. To ensure replicability, we provide cached versions of the raw data that was downloaded from these APIs, but retain the code used to generate them for reference.

R Package Versions

The following R package versions are locked for replication under R 4.4.2. These versions are recorded in `code/dependencies/r_packages.csv` and enforced by `code/dependencies/locked_packages.R`.

Package	Version	Source
`tidyverse`	2.0.0	CRAN
`sf`	1.1-0	CRAN
`haven`	2.5.5	CRAN
`tigris`	2.2.1	CRAN
`stringr`	1.6.0	CRAN
`readxl`	1.4.5	CRAN
`readr`	2.2.0	CRAN
`purrr`	1.2.2	CRAN
`tibble`	3.3.1	CRAN
`terra`	1.9-11	CRAN
`ggplot2`	4.0.3	CRAN
`dplyr`	1.2.1	CRAN
`tidyr`	1.3.2	CRAN
`data.table`	1.18.2.1	CRAN
`stargazer`	5.2.3	CRAN
`randomForest`	4.7-1.2	CRAN
`glmnet`	4.1-10	CRAN
`rpart`	4.1.23	CRAN
`raster`	3.6-32	CRAN

Package	Version	Source
`spatialEco`	2.0-5	CRAN
`elevatr`	0.99.1	CRAN
`parallel`	4.4.2	Base R

ODBC Setup for Census of Governments

Two of the inputs to `code/cleaning/cog_cleaning.do` are provided in `.mdb` format. To use them in Stata requires a connection to an ODBC driver. Below provides instructions on how to create that connection in Windows. For ease of replication, we provide the relevant data from these files converted to `.dta` format and allow the replicator to bypass the code which performs the ODBC conversion with the `load_odbc` flag in `code/master.do`.

The machine running the replication must have an ODBC driver that matches the Stata architecture. For 64-bit Stata on Windows, install the 64-bit Microsoft Access Database Engine / Access ODBC driver if it is not already available, then open the 64-bit ODBC Data Source Administrator at `C:/Windows/System32/odbcad32.exe`. For 32-bit Stata, use the 32-bit administrator at `C:/Windows/SysWOW64/odbcad32.exe`.

Create either User DSNs or System DSNs with these exact names:

- `4_Govt_Org_Directory_Surveys`: point this DSN to the downloaded Census of Governments individual-government directory database in `$RAWDATA/cog/4_Govt_Org_Directory_Surveys/`. The script queries this DSN, reads tables 2–4, and writes `data/interim/cog/4_*.dta`.
- `City_Gov_Fin`: point this DSN to the historical city-government finance database containing table `City_Govt_Finances`. The script writes `data/interim/cog/city_gov_fin.dta`.

After creating the DSNs, test them in Stata before running the full master file:

```
odbc list
odbc query "4_Govt_Org_Directory_Surveys"
odbc query "City_Gov_Fin"
```

If Stata cannot see either DSN, confirm that the DSN was created in the administrator matching the Stata bitness and that the database driver can open the downloaded file. Stata's Windows ODBC FAQ is linked in `code/cleaning/cog_cleaning.do`: `https://www.stata.com/support/faqs/data-management/configuring-odbc-win/`.

Controlled Randomness

Random seed is set at line 2 of program `code/cleaning/white_lasso.R`.

Memory, Runtime, and Storage Requirements

TODO: Add the machine specifications, operating system, memory, runtime, and storage requirements from a clean full run of `code/master.do`.

Approximate runtime category:

☐ Less than 10 minutes
☐ 10–60 minutes
☐ 1–2 hours
☐ 2–8 hours

- ☐ 8–24 hours
- ☐ 1–3 days
- ☐ 3–14 days
- ☐ More than 14 days

Approximate storage requirement:

- ☐ Less than 25 MB
- ☐ 25 MB–250 MB
- ☐ 250 MB–2 GB
- ☐ 2 GB–25 GB
- ☑ 25 GB–250 GB
- ☐ More than 250 GB

Description of Programs and Code

`code/master.do` is the master script. It performs the following steps:

1. Sets user-specific paths, Stata version, Stata globals, and the ado path.
2. Writes `paths.csv`, which several R scripts read to recover Stata global paths.
3. Copies edited Derenoncourt setup scripts into the Derenoncourt replication directory via `code/cleaning/dcourt_file_setup.do`.
4. Runs the edited Derenoncourt replication master file at `$RAWDATA/dcourt/replication_AER/code/0_MASTER_edited.do`.
5. Runs cleaning scripts under `code/cleaning`.
6. Runs analysis scripts under `code/analysis`.

Cleaning Code

The cleaning stage constructs crosswalks, Derenoncourt-derived inputs, municipal counts, Census/IPUMS/NHGIS-derived controls, spatial covariates, school and court-order inputs, and the final clean analysis datasets. Key outputs are `data/clean/cz_pooled.dta`, `data/clean/mechanisms.dta`, `data/clean/panel_a_data.dta`, and `data/clean/pcarrow_fig_data.dta`.

Analysis Code

The analysis stage reads the cleaned datasets and writes manuscript and appendix outputs to `exhibits/tables` and `exhibits/figures`. Stata helper programs in `code/ado` produce repeated table formats and shift-share/segregation calculations.

License for Code

TODO: Specify the code license. The repository includes `LICENSE`; confirm whether the license is intended for all code in the replication package and whether any bundled third-party code or ado files require separate notices.

Instructions to Replicators

1. Ensure you have the required versions of Stata 17 and R 4.4.2.
2. Setup Census of Governments ODBC connections and set `load_odbc=1` in `code/master.do` or use the pre-converted files and set `load_odbc=0`.
3. Unzip the Derenoncourt (2022b) replication package to `data/raw/dcourt/replication_AER/`. Follow their instructions for obtaining the data sets which are restricted to non-ICPSR members (ICPSR 20, 7735, 7736, and 8493) and download them to their expected location.
4. Edit the path block near the top of `code/master.do` so that `$DROPBOX`, `$REPO`, and `$Rterm_path` point to local paths on the replicator's machine.
5. In Stata, from the repository root, run `code/master.do`.
6. Outputs will be written to `exhibits/tables` and `exhibits/figures`.

List of Tables, Figures, and Programs

The provided code is intended to reproduce:

☑ All numbers provided in text in the paper.
☑ All tables and figures in the paper.
☐ Selected tables and figures in the paper, as explained below.

TODO: Check the appropriate box after comparing this output list with the final manuscript and appendix.

Figure/Table	Program	Output file(s)	Notes
Table 1	`code/analysis/summary_table.do`	`exhibits/tables/T1.tex`	Summary statistics.
Table 2	`code/analysis/main_table.do`; `main_table_long_ssaggregate.ado`	`exhibits/tables/T2.tex`	Main 2SLS table.
Table 3	`code/analysis/main_table.do`; `fragmech_long_ssaggregate.ado`	`exhibits/tables/T3.tex`	Fragmentation/mechanism table.
Table 4	`code/analysis/occscore_links_diffs_ss.do`	`exhibits/tables/T4.tex`	Linked OCCSCORE heterogeneity. **TODO:** Confirm manuscript title.
Table 5	`code/analysis/long_term_mechanisms.do`	`exhibits/tables/T5.tex`	Long-term mechanisms.
Table 6	`code/analysis/segregation_table.do`	`exhibits/tables/T6.tex`	Long-term segregation and achievement-related outcomes.
Figure 1, panels D–E	`code/analysis/fig_1_panels_b_c.do`	`exhibits/figures/F1d.pdf`; `F1e.pdf`	**TODO:** Confirm panel labels; program name says panels B/C.
Figure 2, panels A–B	`code/analysis/event_studies.do`	`exhibits/figures/F2a.png`; `F2b.png`	Event studies.
Figure 3, panels A–B	`code/analysis/pcarrow_fig.do`	`exhibits/figures/F3a.pdf`; `F3b.pdf`	Principal-city arrow figures.
Appendix Table A1	`code/analysis/balancetables.do`	`exhibits/tables/TA1.tex`	Balance table for baseline instrument.
Appendix Table A2	`code/analysis/pretrends.do`	`exhibits/tables/TA2.tex`	Pre-trends table.
Appendix Table A3	`code/analysis/main_table.do`	`exhibits/tables/TA3.tex`	Town outcome robustness.
Appendix Table A4	`code/analysis/corr_matrix.do`	`exhibits/tables/TA4.tex`	Correlation matrix.
Appendix Tables A5–A7	`code/analysis/main_table.do`	`TA5.tex`; `TA6.tex`; `TA7.tex`	Main-table robustness variants.
Appendix Tables A8–A12	`code/analysis/imbalance_decomp.do`	`TA8.tex`–`TA12.tex`	Imbalanced-controls decomposition for `cgoodman`, `gen_muni`, `schdist_ind`, `spdist`, and `totfrac`.

Figure/Table	Program	Output file(s)	Notes
Appendix Tables A13–A14	`code/analysis/main_table.do`	`TA13.tex`; `TA14.tex`	Control-set robustness.
Appendix Table A15 and auxiliary files	`code/analysis/balancecontrols_individualeffects.do`	`TA15.tex`; `balancecontrols_rf.tex`; `balancecontrols_rf_sep.tex`	Baseline controls individual effects and auxiliary reduced-form balance files. **TODO:** Confirm whether auxiliary files appear in manuscript/appendix.
Appendix Table A16	`code/analysis/balancetables.do`	`exhibits/tables/TA16.tex`	Percentile instrument balance table.
Appendix Table A17	`code/analysis/main_table.do`	`exhibits/tables/TA17.tex`	Non-ssaggregate / alternative instrument version. **TODO:** Confirm description.
Appendix Table A18	`code/analysis/main_table.do`	`exhibits/tables/TA18.tex`	Weighted instrument-migration robustness.
Appendix Table A19	`code/analysis/balancetables.do`	`exhibits/tables/TA19.tex`	White migration balance table.
Appendix Table A20	`code/analysis/main_table.do`	`exhibits/tables/TA20.tex`	White migration robustness table.
Appendix Tables A21–A22	`code/analysis/occscore_links_diffs_fs.do`	`TA21.tex`; `TA22.tex`	First-stage linked OCCSCORE heterogeneity by links/differences.
Appendix Table A23	`code/analysis/touching_pct_rev_debt_table.do`	`exhibits/tables/TA23.tex`	Boundary/revenue/debt mechanisms.
Appendix Table A24	`code/analysis/main_court_ordered.do`	`exhibits/tables/TA24.tex`	Court-ordered heterogeneity.
Appendix Table A25	`code/analysis/white_flight_check.do`	`exhibits/tables/TA25.tex`	White-flight check.
Appendix Figure A1	`code/analysis/municipal_incorporations_graph.do`	`exhibits/figures/FA1.png`	Municipal incorporations over time.

Figure/Table	Program	Output file(s)	Notes
Appendix Figure A2 series	code/analysis/loo_test.do	FA2_<outcome>.pdf	Leave-one-out tests for cgoodman, gen_muni, gen_town, schdist_ind, spdist, totfrac.
Appendix Figure A3 series	code/analysis/alt_inst_tests.do	FA3_<outcome>.pdf	Alternative instrument tests for the same outcome family.
Appendix Figure A4 series	code/analysis/placebo_test.do	FA4_<outcome>.pdf	Derenoncourt placebo tests for the same outcome family.
Appendix Figures A5a–A5b	code/analysis/dist_edge_edge.do	FA5a.pdf; FA5b.pdf	Distance to principal city graphs.

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